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Gyroscope

Invented in 1852 by Leon Foucault, and with a prototype developed by Johann von Bohnenberger in 1817, the gyroscope is capable of magic. Really.

A gyroscope can balance itself on a string or a finger, and resists falling down even when in very odd positions. This effect is said to be because of a combination of angular momentum and torque. When the ring inside spins, a force is generated which acts perpendicular to the spin of the disk. This is what keeps it up and a resultant behaviour called ‘precession’ is